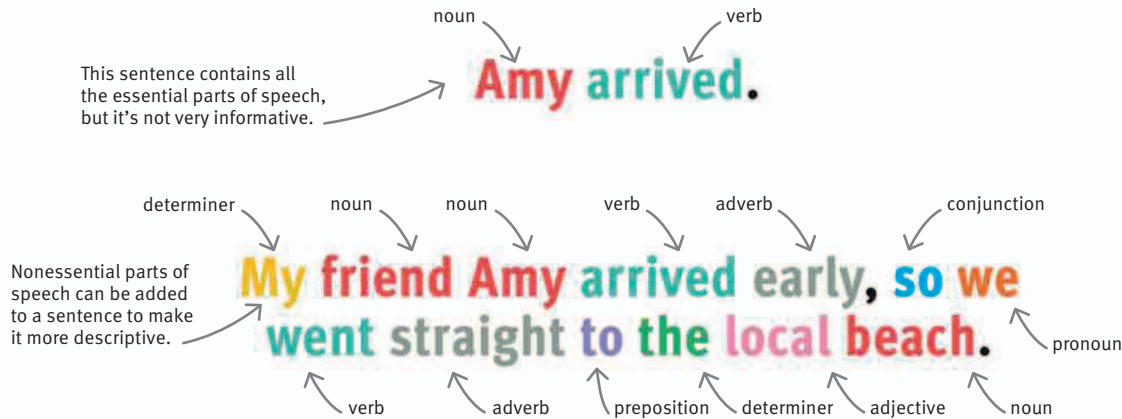


Parts of speech

Words are grouped together according to the functions they perform in a sentence. There are ten parts of speech in English. Nouns (or pronouns) and verbs are essential to

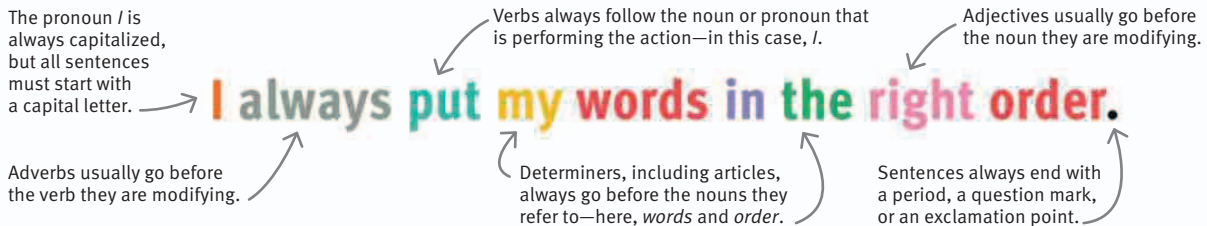
the structure of a sentence, but it's the other parts of speech, including adjectives, adverbs, conjunctions, and prepositions, that make a sentence interesting.



Structuring sentences

Without the rules of grammar, words would be placed in a random order, and no one would be able to understand what anyone else was saying. An ability to communicate effectively comes from following these rules. A sentence

must also be correctly punctuated for it to make sense. Grammar explains which order to put words in, while punctuation marks such as periods and commas indicate how the sentence should be read.



Everyday grammar

A good grasp of grammar enables people to speak and write clearly and concisely, and to understand all kinds of reading material. These skills are invaluable when it comes to job applications, as employers will always show a preference for candidates who have submitted grammatically correct

applications. Similarly, candidates who can express themselves clearly will be more successful in interviews. Good grammar improves creative writing, too, and even the best-known writers—past and present—have followed a few simple rules.

“My suffering left me sad and gloomy.”

The opening line from Yann Martel's *Life of Pi* follows the rules because it starts with a noun, followed by a verb, and includes adjectives that make the sentence memorable.